

1. sqlite-utils 4.2.1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-13T23:53:47+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/13/sqlite-utils-2/>

Release: sqlite-utils 4.2.1 Fixes a crashing bug in sqlite-utils 4.2 . I'd introduced code that looks like this: `from typing_extensions import Self` It turned out the typing-extensions package was not listed as a dependency for sqlite-utils - it was installed by one of the other dependencies in the dev dependency group , but when you `uvx sqlite-utils` directly you don't get those dependencies. As part of fixing this I figured out how to run a smoke test to ensure the CLI tool still works even without those dev dependencies, which can be run from the project checkout: `uv run --isolated --no-default-groups sqlite-utils --help` The `--no-default-groups` argument prevents it from installing that default dev group, and `--isolated` means that even if there is a `.venv/` folder containing extra dependencies they will be ignored for the duration of that `uv run` command. Tags: packaging , python , sqlite-utils , uv

2. sqlite-utils 4.2

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-13T20:11:29+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/13/sqlite-utils/>

Release: sqlite-utils 4.2 Lots of improvements in this one relating to the `table.transform()` feature , which adds support for complex alter table operations by creating a fresh table, copying across the data and then dropping and replacing the old one. `transform()` now preserves a much larger array of edge-case schema definitions, including check constraints, unique constraints and even comments describing the columns. There are also new introspection properties for check constraints, and a whole lot of other smaller changes. Includes contributions from Bunlong Heng , ethanhawkes-gif , Rami Abdelrazzaq , nyxst4ck , and ikatyal2110 . (It later turned out 4.2 had a crashing bug , fixed in 4.2.1 .) Tags: releases , sqlite , sqlite-utils

3. llm-gemini 0.33

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-13T19:37:34+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/13/llm-gemini/>

Release: llm-gemini 0.33 It's been a while since the last llm-gemini release. This version of the plugin adds support for today's Gemini 3.7 Flash release, plus `gemini-3.6-flash` , `gemini-3.5-flash-lite` and two embedding models `gemini-embedding-2` and `gemini-embedding-001` . The plugin is also upgraded for compatibility with LLM 0.32, which means you can now see reasoning traces and you can also enable server-side tools using this pattern: `llm -m gemini-3.7-flash -T CodeExecution \ 'use python to calculate (factorial of 13) * 3'` I had Gemini 3.7 Flash draw me some pelicans riding bicycles at high, medium, and low thinking efforts (minimal, which was an option in 3.6 Flash, has been removed in 3.7.) Here's the high level one, which is pretty great: One catch though: the pelican I showed here was rendered with Safari. Both Firefox and Chrome render it differently, due to Safari being more tolerant of empty SVG elements than those other two browsers. They still display the bicycle, but the pelican is missing entirely! Tags: google , ai , generative-ai , llms , llm , gemini , pelican-riding-a-bicycle , llm-release

4. The comments that go into code versus those that go into the pull request description

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 12 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260812-00/?p=112607>

Understanding the temporal relevance. The post The comments that go into code versus those that go into the pull request description appeared first on The Old New Thing .

5. Ceramic Shield 2 Is the Real Deal

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-13T15:46:41Z

Link: <https://www.tomsguide.com/phones/iphones/iphone-17-and-iphone-air-durability-testing-here-s-how-the-new-iphones-stand-up-to-bending-scratching-and-dropping>

Philip Michaels, writing last September for Tom's Guide: iPhone 17 torture test videos done by JerryRigEverything indicate that Ceramic Shield 2 certainly resists scratching, with scratch testing leaving only light scratches at level 7 on the Mohs scale of hardness. Scratches typically show up on glass at levels 5 or 6 on that scale. Ceramic Shield 2 is indeed the best we've ever seen, JerryRigEverything remarks in the iPhone 17 Pro testing video. That backs up Apple's own Ceramic Shield 2 video, in which a mineral tip can be seen rubbing against a Ceramic Shield 2-coated display. There's residue left on the screen, but it's material from that tip, as it wipes away fairly easily. I mentioned yesterday that I try never to place my iPhones face down, to avoid scratches, and that my nearly year-old iPhone 17 Pro seemingly has not one visible scratch on the front glass. Not even a single micro abrasion I can see, even when tilting it with the display off to hunt for them. Surely Apple's Ceramic Shield 2, which is intended to provide best-ever scratch resistance, is a factor too? and likely the biggest factor. Apple at its best.?

6. TechCrunch on Google's Pixel 11 Lineup

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-12T19:45:58Z

Link: <https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/12/pixel-11-has-few-hardware-changes-and-more-gemini/>

Ivan Mehta, TechCrunch: With this year's Pixel 11 series launch, Google is thinking more agentic AI to complete your tasks. With Gemini, U.S.-based users will be able to order groceries, book rides, or get coffee, for instance. Plus, Gemini can call businesses on users' behalf for table reservations or appointments. Google said that users can take over or stop tasks at any point in time and also review transcripts for AI-operated calls. Over the next few weeks, a new slate of connected apps will be able to work with Gemini to get things done, including Granola, Otter.ai, Wix, Fever, Get Your Guide, Localiza, OpenTable (U.K.), Ticketmaster, iHeartRadio, Pandora, Angi, Thumbtack, and Zocdoc. I've never heard of most of those apps, or, if I have heard of them, I thought they went defunct years ago. The one app amongst those I do use, OpenTable, apparently only supports this Gemini integration in the U.K.? Another knockout year for the Pixel phones and Android.?

7. Hands-On With Google Pixel 11 Pro Fold

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-12T19:40:51Z

Link: <https://www.engadget.com/2235294/google-pixel-11-pro-fold-hands-on/>

Sam Rutherford, writing for Engadget: Granted, the P11 Pro Fold still includes IP68 dust and water resistance, which is better than what you get on the Z Fold 8 line (IP48). But after making an absolute tank of a foldable phone with last year's model, I said Google really needed to cut weight and thickness this generation, and it just hasn't. Instead, it seems like Google has leaned even more into the Pro Fold's sturdiness with a new glass fibre material for its rear panel that the company says is nearly impossible to crack. This is great in theory, but obviously I wasn't in a position to smash one of Google's demo units in order to test that claim. I have never seen anyone, anywhere, with a folding Pixel phone. Pretty sure I won't this year either. I played with a Pixel 10 Fold or whatever its name was last year at the Google Store on Newbury street in Boston, which store felt like a small library or museum. The Pixel Fold display was so plasticky that I had a moment where I wondered if the display units were fake props, like at Ikea. But no, it was the real thing. And it cost \$1,800 to start.?

8. Hadamard Codes and Sphere Packing

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 01:35:05 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/13/hadamard-sphere-packing/>

Yesterday Levent Alpöge announced that he and his colleagues had discovered a new Hadamard matrix using Claude AI. That motivated a post I wrote this morning on how to construct Hadamard matrices. I mentioned in that post that these matrices arise in applications. This evening I gave an example, describing how NASA used a Hadamard [?] The post Hadamard Codes and Sphere Packing first appeared on John D. Cook.

9. How NASA's Mariner 9 probe encoded images

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 23:54:21 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/13/mariner-hadamard/>

NASA set Mariner 9 to photograph Mars in 1971. The images had to be encoded for transmission using an error-correcting code, otherwise they would be significantly corrupted when they were received on Earth. The images were encoded for transmission using a code based on Hadamard matrices, specifically a (32, 6, 16) Hadamard code. This means [?] The post How NASA's Mariner 9 probe encoded images first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Constructing Hadamard matrices

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 15:02:41 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/13/constructing-hadamard-matrices/>

A Hadamard matrix is an orthogonal matrix whose entries are all either 1 or -1. For example is a Hadamard matrix of order 2. True to Stigler's law of eponymy, James Joseph Sylvester investigated Hadamard matrices before Jacques Hadamard. Sylvester saw how to bootstrap the example above into more examples. If H is a [?] The post Constructing Hadamard matrices first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Edinburgh Fringe: Doris, Dolly and the Dressing Room Divas ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 22:23:25 +0000

Link:

<https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-doris-dolly-and-the-dressing-room-divas/>

Quite simply marvellous! Three Scottish divas giving us their interpretations of the greats while backed by an excellent pianist. So many shows at the Fringe skimp on sets and props - not this! A luscious array of costumes, hats, wigs, and ruby slippers bring the characters to life. The framing is thin but serviceable - the backstage helpers are reminiscing about their favourite stars and bring ?

12. Edinburgh Fringe: The Musical Mystery Caller ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 20:21:53 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-the-musical-mystery-caller/>

Walking down the street, I noticed a ringing phone box so, naturally, I answered it. What happened next was a few minutes of pure fringe magic! I had a little chat with the caller, he welcomed me to the smallest venue in the fringe, and then he improvised a banger of a song based on my peculiar proclivities. What a treat to have a front row experience at a one man (and one audience member)?

13. Edinburgh Fringe: Miscast Sondheim ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 18:45:15 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-miscast-sondheim/>

I'm not sure what they're teaching at LAMDA, but it certainly isn't vocal projection. We were forewarned about the technical difficulties - but if a trained stage singer can't reach the 6th row of a tiny theatre, that can't be blamed on the backstage team. The show advertises itself as: What happens when you take Sondheim's most beloved music and turn it on its head? Inquiries become villains, vi?

14. Supplier Security Questionnaire

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-13T17:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/13/supplier-security-questionnaire.html>

From: Third-Party Risk Management To: [address extracted from package metadata] Subject: ACTION REQUIRED: Annual Supplier Security Assessment Due: 5 business days from receipt Hi, Our software inventory has identified you as the supplier of a software component in our production estate (the 'Component'). All such suppliers are required to complete our standard security assessment annually. We were unable to locate a procurement contact for your organisation and

are reaching out to the address in the package manifest. Where a question does not apply, please state why. Blank responses are scored as a fail. Estimated time to complete: 20 minutes. Kind regards, D. Ligence Third-Party Risk Management Section 1: General 1.1 Name of the Component. 1.2 URL of the primary source repository. 1.3 The OSI-approved licence under which the Component is distributed. 1.4 Monitored group mailbox for the maintainer team. 1.5 Current GitHub star count for the primary repository. 1.6 Please account for any period of thirty days or more in the past twelve months during which no commits were made to the primary repository. Section 2: Security 2.1 URL of the supplier's published vulnerability disclosure...

15. Another partial SSI trick with canonicalize

Source: Max Bernstein's Blog | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: https://bernsteinbear.com/blog/more-partial-ssi/?utm_source=rss

After reading Chris Fallin's aegraph post, new ZJIT contributor dak2 landed a block-local version of the canonicalize function in #16828. The pseudocode of the block-local canonicalize function looks like this: for block in function . reverse_post_order(): rewrite_map = {} for insn in block . insns : insn . operands . map_in_place (lambda o : rewrite_map . get (o , o)) if insn . opcode == "GuardType" : rewrite_map [insn . val] = insn As a refresher, this turns IR like this: v0:Object = ... v1:Int = GuardType v0, Int ... do something with v1 v2:Int = GuardType v0, Int ... do something with v2 into this: v0:Object = ... v1:Int = GuardType v0, Int ... do something with v1 v2:Int = GuardType v1, Int ... do something with v2 Note that the second use of v0 has been turned into v1. This is important because a later constant-folding pass can observe that the input v1 of GuardType v1, Int is already an Int and can therefore replace all uses of v2 with v1 and delete the guard. Because in this local version we make a new rewrite_map for each block, we don't carry any rewrites across blocks (but ZJIT still gained a lot because until recently its IR was in maximal SSA form, so a block...